

NATHAN B. SMITH

4145 Arizona St., Apt. 7 • San Diego, CA 92104 • (858) 221-3649 • nbsmith@outlook.com
linkedin.com/in/nathanbsmith92163

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Senior Principal Technical Writer with 15+ years of experience producing DoD-compliant documentation for defense, aerospace, and industrial programs. Proven expertise in authoring, editing, and maintaining technical manuals, IETMs, training curricula, and illustrated parts catalogs for C5ISR, UAS, naval weapons, and advanced manufacturing systems. Navy Surface Warfare Officer veteran with 23+ years of service; deep familiarity with military operations, communications systems, and clearance-sensitive environments. Secret clearance currently ACTIVE, eligible for upgrade. Proficient in PTC Arbortext, S1000D, MIL-SPEC standards, Simplified Technical English (STE), and modern content management systems.

CORE COMPETENCIES

DoD Technical Writing & Editing • S1000D / MIL-SPEC Standards • C5ISR Systems Documentation • Training Curriculum Development

Version Control & Configuration Management • PTC Arbortext / Windchill • Illustrated Parts Catalogs • SME Collaboration • Simplified Technical English

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Senior Principal Technical Writer | Northrop Grumman | January 2024 – January 2026 | San Diego, CA

- Authored and maintained S1000D-conformant Interactive Electronic Technical Manuals (IETMs) for the RQ-4 Global Hawk Unmanned Aircraft System, a classified DoD C5ISR platform.
- Managed technical content lifecycle in the Astoria Component Content Management System, ensuring version control, configuration management, and audit-trail compliance.
- Collaborated with systems engineers, program managers, and SMEs to capture and document operational procedures, maintenance tasks, and troubleshooting workflows.
- Revised and redlined technical publications to reflect engineering change proposals (ECPs) and system upgrades, maintaining accuracy across IETMs and associated drawings.
- Developed and updated training curriculum materials aligned to evolving Global Hawk system configurations and modernized avionics components.

Technical Writer | General Atomics – Electromagnetic Systems | July 2023 – September 2023 | San Diego, CA

- Produced technical manuals and documentation for the Electromagnetic Aircraft Launch System (EALS) aboard Gerald R. Ford-class carriers, supporting a flagship DoD advanced manufacturing and naval systems program.
- Authored maintenance and operational procedures from engineering drawings, schematics, and direct SME interviews.

Technical Writer – Aftermarket Technical Services | Collins Aerospace | January 2018 – March 2023 | Chula Vista, CA

- Produced Aircraft Maintenance Manuals (AMMs), Component Maintenance Manuals (CMMs), Structural Repair Manuals (SRMs), Illustrated Parts Catalogs (IPCs), and Service Bulletins for Boeing and Airbus commercial aircraft programs under ATA100/iSpec2200 standards.
- Maintained version control of all publications using product lifecycle management tools, coordinating updates across engineering, quality, and compliance teams.
- Edited and reviewed documentation prepared by other writers to ensure style, terminology, and technical accuracy compliance.

Senior Technical Writer | Thermo Fisher Scientific | May 2017 – December 2017 | Carlsbad, CA

- Developed user manuals and technical documentation for complex scientific instrumentation, synthesizing content from engineering specifications and usability testing.

Systems Engineer / Technical Writer | Engility Corporation | November 2015 – June 2016 | San Diego, CA

- Combined systems engineering and technical writing responsibilities supporting DoD programs; documented system architectures, operational concepts, and test procedures.

Logistics Planner / Technical Writer | Northrop Grumman Aerospace Systems | April 2015 – November 2015 | San Diego, CA

- Supported logistics planning and technical documentation for aerospace systems programs.

Senior Technical Writer | Qualcomm | September 2008 – June 2012 | San Diego, CA

- Authored comprehensive technical publications for wireless communications products; collaborated with hardware and software engineers to produce accurate, user-focused documentation.

Logistics Planner / Senior Technical Writer | Solar Turbines | September 2006 – April 2007 | San Diego, CA

- Developed Illustrated Parts Lists (IPLs) and Operation & Maintenance Instruction Manuals (OMIs) for new production gas turbine-driven compressors and generators.
- Utilized PTC Arbortext, Windchill, and Pro/ENGINEER in a full-production documentation environment.

Surface Warfare Officer | U.S. Navy | September 1985 – December 2008 | Worldwide

- Served 23 years as a commissioned officer; authored operational and maintenance guidebooks for tactical C5ISR and communications systems.
- Led and supervised teams in high-stakes technical environments; held security clearance throughout active-duty career.
- Extensive experience with DoD documentation standards, military writing conventions, and interoperability requirements for naval command, control, and communications systems.

CERTIFICATIONS

Associate Systems Engineering Professional (ASEP) – International Council on Systems Engineering (INCOSE), July 2026

EDUCATION

Doctor of Computer Science (D.C.S.), Big Data Analytics – Colorado Technical University (Conferred June 2024)

Master of Science (M.S.), Wireless Communications – National University, San Diego, CA (Conferred 2013)

Master of Business Administration (M.B.A.), Technology Management – National University, San Diego, CA (Conferred 2010)

Bachelor of Science (B.S.), Biology – American University, Washington, DC (Conferred 1983)

TECHNICAL SKILLS & TOOLS

Authoring & CMS: PTC Arbortext, Astoria CCMS, Windchill, Adobe Acrobat, Microsoft Office Suite, Adobe FrameMaker

Standards & Methodologies: S1000D, ATA iSpec 2200, ATA100, MIL-SPEC/MIL-STD, Simplified Technical English (STE ASD-STE100), DoD configuration management

Engineering Tools: Pro/ENGINEER (PTC Creo), CAD drawing interpretation, schematics analysis, BOMs

Security Clearance: Secret – currently ACTIVE; eligible for upgrade